

Turkey Meatballs

with Carrot Noodles and Tomato-Basil Sauce

Inspired by her Italian heritage, *Inspiralized* author Ali Maffucci transformed this classic dish with carrot "noodles" in place of spaghetti. Seared turkey meatballs keep this one rooted firmly in childhood memories of comforting deliciousness. Plus, you can still twirl your fork to your heart's content.

35-45 minutes 2 servings 700 calories per serving

Plated.

Ingredients

- 1 pound jumbo carrot
- ⅛ ounce parsley
- ¼ ounce basil, divided
- 3 cloves garlic, divided
- 1 red onion, divided
- 12 ounces ground turkey
- ¼ cup gluten-free breadcrumbs
- ⅓ cup grated pecorino cheese, divided
- ½ tablespoon tomato paste, divided
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 1 can crushed tomatoes

You'll Need

- 3 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 egg
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- 12" large pan with lid

Recipe Tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

Large carrots are easiest for creating long, noodle-like ribbons. To yield wide, even ribbons, hold one end of the carrot firmly while peeling. Frequently rotate the carrot, yielding as many ribbons as you can until you reach the thin center.

Want to know more about spiralizing? Check out Inspiralized.com for more info!

USDA recommends cooking ground turkey to 160°F.

Great food starts with great ingredients. We're proud to send you turkey raised without antibiotics.



1. Prepare Ingredients

Rinse **carrot**, peel outer layer, and discard. Using the vegetable peeler, continue peeling carrot lengthwise into wide ribbons (see Recipe Tip). Rinse **parsley** and **basil**. Roughly chop leaves, discarding stems. Mince **garlic**. Peel **onion** and halve, then cut half into small dice. Pat **turkey** dry with paper towel. Save remaining onion for another homemade meal.



2. Make Meatballs

In a large bowl, combine **turkey**, **parsley**, **breadcrumbs**, **half of basil**, **half of garlic**, **half of diced onion**, **half of pecorino**, **half of tomato paste**, and **1 egg**. Season with **½ teaspoon salt** and **pepper** as desired. Using your hands, mix well, then form into 8-10 equal balls, about 1½-inches in diameter.



3. Sear Meatballs

Heat **2 tablespoons olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **meatballs** and sear, turning occasionally, until browned on all sides, 8-10 minutes total. Transfer to a paper towel-lined plate to drain.



4. Make Tomato-Basil Sauce

Wipe pan from meatballs clean and return to medium heat. Immediately add **1 tablespoon olive oil**, **oregano**, **remaining garlic**, and **remaining diced onion**. Cook until onion is soft and translucent, 3-5 minutes. Add **remaining tomato paste** and cook until fully combined, 1-2 minutes more. Add **crushed tomatoes** and season with **¼ teaspoon salt** and **pepper** as desired. Increase heat to medium-high.



5. Cook Carrots

When sauce begins to bubble, return **meatballs** to pan and spoon over sauce. Reduce heat to medium and cover. Simmer until meatballs are cooked through, 5-7 minutes. Transfer **meatballs** to a plate and add **carrot ribbons** to pan with sauce. Stir to coat and cook until carrots are just softened, 3-4 minutes. Remove pan from heat and stir in **remaining basil**. Taste and season with **salt** and **pepper** as desired.



6. Plate Spaghetti and Meatballs

Divide **carrot ribbons** and **tomato-basil sauce** between 2 plates. Top with **turkey meatballs** and **remaining pecorino**, and dig in.

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